

Linear Models Lecture 13: Instrumental Variables

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Structural vs. Projection Parameters

- Recall from our earlier lectures: OLS estimates the **best linear predictor** (projection).
- A **structural model** posits a causal data-generating process:

$$Y = \mathbf{x}'\beta + e$$

- We can always define a projection: $\beta^* = (\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}\mathbf{x}'])^{-1}\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}Y]$, with $\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}e^*] = 0$.
- When $\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}e] \neq 0$:

$$\beta^* = \beta + (\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}\mathbf{x}'])^{-1}\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}e] \neq \beta$$

- OLS is **inconsistent** for the structural parameter: $\hat{\beta} \xrightarrow{P} \beta^* \neq \beta$.
- We call $\mathbf{x}$ **endogenous** when this occurs.

Endogeneity Source 1: Measurement Error

- The true structural model is $\mathbb{E}[Y \mid \mathbf{z}] = \mathbf{z}'\beta$, but we don't observe $\mathbf{z}$.
- Our measured variables: $\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{z} + \mathbf{u}$, where $\mathbf{u}$ is measurement error.
- Assumptions on the error:
 - $\text{plim} \frac{\mathbf{z}'\mathbf{u}}{n} = 0$: measurement error uncorrelated with truth
 - $\text{plim} \frac{\mathbf{e}'\mathbf{u}}{n} = 0$: measurement error uncorrelated with structural disturbance
- **Political science examples:**
 - Survey-reported ideology (ANES self-placement on liberal–conservative scale)
 - GDP in developing countries used in aid allocation studies
 - Self-reported voter turnout (overreported by $\sim 10\text{--}15\%$)

Measurement Error: Rewriting in Observables

- Substitute $\mathbf{z} = \mathbf{x} - \mathbf{u}$ into the structural equation:

$$\begin{aligned} Y &= \mathbf{z}'\beta + e \\ &= (\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{u})'\beta + e \\ &= \mathbf{x}'\beta + \underbrace{(e - \mathbf{u}'\beta)}_{\equiv \nu} \end{aligned}$$

- But $\mathbf{x}$ and ν are correlated:

$$\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}\nu] = \mathbb{E}[(\mathbf{z} + \mathbf{u})(e - \mathbf{u}'\beta)] = -\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{u}\mathbf{u}']\beta \neq 0$$

- The measurement error in regressors creates endogeneity, even though the true model is correctly specified.

Measurement Error: Attenuation Bias

- The OLS probability limit:

$$\begin{aligned}\text{plim } \hat{\beta} &= \beta + \left(\text{plim } \frac{\mathbf{X}'\mathbf{X}}{n} \right)^{-1} \text{plim } \frac{\mathbf{X}'\mathbf{u}}{n} \beta \\ &= \beta - \Sigma_X^{-1} \Sigma_u \beta \\ &= \left(\mathbf{I} - \underbrace{\Sigma_X^{-1}}_{\text{signal}} \underbrace{\Sigma_u}_{\text{noise}} \right) \beta\end{aligned}$$

- In the scalar case: $\text{plim } \hat{\beta} = \frac{\sigma_z^2}{\sigma_z^2 + \sigma_u^2} \beta$
- OLS is biased **toward zero** — this is **attenuation bias**.
- Even if only one variable has measurement error, it affects **all** slope coefficients.

Measurement Error Example: Ideology and Voting

- **Question:** Does ideological extremism reduce electoral support?

$$\text{VoteShare}_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \text{Ideology}_i^* + \mathbf{x}_i' \gamma + e_i$$

- $\text{Ideology}_i^* =$ true ideological position (unobserved).
- We measure ideology with error:

$$\text{Ideology}_i = \text{Ideology}_i^* + u_i$$

(e.g., survey responses, roll-call scores like DW-NOMINATE).

- Attenuation bias: OLS **underestimates** the penalty for extremism.
- **IV solution:** Use a second measure of ideology (e.g., campaign finance scores, CFscores) as an instrument — it shares the true signal but has independent measurement error.

Endogeneity Source 2: Simultaneity

- Two equations are jointly determined — each variable is both cause and effect.
- **Classic example:** Arms races (Richardson model).

$$\text{MilSpend}_A = \alpha_0 + \alpha_1 \text{MilSpend}_B + e_A$$

$$\text{MilSpend}_B = \gamma_0 + \gamma_1 \text{MilSpend}_A + e_B$$

- MilSpend_B appears on the RHS of equation 1, but is determined in equation 2 (which depends on MilSpend_A).
- OLS on either equation is inconsistent: the regressor is correlated with the error by construction.
- **Other examples:** Trade policy and trade flows; campaign spending and vote share; policing levels and crime rates.

Endogeneity Source 3: Endogenous Choice (Selection)

- Agents **choose** their treatment based on expected gains (Roy 1951).
- Potential outcomes: $Y_i(1) = \mathbf{x}_i' \beta_1 + e_{1i}$, $Y_i(0) = \mathbf{x}_i' \beta_0 + e_{0i}$.
- Selection rule: individual chooses treatment if net benefit exceeds threshold:

$$D_i = \mathbb{1}\{\mathbf{z}_i' \gamma + \eta_i > 0\}, \quad \eta_i = e_{1i} - e_{0i}$$

- If η_i and e_{1i} are correlated:

$$\mathbb{E}[e_{1i} \mid D_i = 1] = \mathbb{E}[e_{1i} \mid \mathbf{z}_i' \gamma + \eta_i > 0] \neq 0$$

- OLS on the treated sample is **biased** — we only observe outcomes for those who chose treatment.
- If $\mathbf{z}$ includes variables excluded from $\mathbf{x}$, we have an **exclusion restriction**.

Endogenous Choice: Political Selection

- **Question:** Does holding office increase personal wealth?

$$\text{Wealth}_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \text{HeldOffice}_i + \mathbf{x}'_i \gamma + e_i$$

- Problem: Who runs for office? Who wins?
 - Wealthier individuals may be more likely to run and win
 - More politically connected individuals may both win and accumulate wealth
 - Selection on gains: those who expect to profit most from office seek it out
- Observed difference = **ATT** + **Selection bias**:

$$\mathbb{E}[\text{Wealth} \mid \text{Office} = 1] - \mathbb{E}[\text{Wealth} \mid \text{Office} = 0]$$

- **IV solution:** Use close election outcomes (regression discontinuity / Lee 2008) as an instrument — winning a close race is quasi-random.

Selection Bias Decomposition

- The observed difference in outcomes:

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}[Y \mid D=1] - \mathbb{E}[Y \mid D=0] &= \underbrace{\mathbb{E}[Y(1) - Y(0) \mid D=1]}_{\text{ATT}} \\ &\quad + \underbrace{\mathbb{E}[Y(0) \mid D=1] - \mathbb{E}[Y(0) \mid D=0]}_{\text{Type I: Selection on levels}}\end{aligned}$$

- If treatment effects are heterogeneous ($\tau_i = Y_i(1) - Y_i(0)$ varies):

$$\mathbb{E}[\tau_i \mid D=1] \neq \mathbb{E}[\tau_i] \quad \Rightarrow \quad \text{Type II: Selection on gains}$$

- **Type I:** Officeholders would have been wealthier anyway (baseline differences).
- **Type II:** Those who gain most from office are most likely to seek it (differential returns).

The Common Thread

In all three cases — measurement error, simultaneity, selection — the core problem is $\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}e] \neq 0$. The solution: find an instrument Z .

Source	Why $\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}e] \neq 0$	IV strategy
Measurement error	Noise in $\mathbf{x}$ enters error	Second measure of $\mathbf{x}^*$
Simultaneity	Y and X jointly determined	Exogenous shifter of one eq.
Selection/omitted var.	Choice correlated with e	Excluded exogenous variable

Notation: Structural Equation (Hansen Ch. 12)

- Y is a linear function of exogenous variables $\mathbf{x}_1$ and endogenous variables $\mathbf{y}_2$:

$$Y_1 = \mathbf{x}'_1 \beta_1 + \mathbf{y}'_2 \beta_2 + e, \quad \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{y}_2 e] \neq 0$$

- **Instruments:** $\mathbf{z} = (\mathbf{z}'_1, \mathbf{z}'_2)'$, dimension $l \times 1$:
 - $\mathbf{z}_1 = \mathbf{x}_1$: included instruments (the exogenous regressors), dimension k_1
 - $\mathbf{z}_2$: excluded instruments, dimension $l_2 \geq k_2$
- Writing $\mathbf{x} = (\mathbf{x}'_1, \mathbf{y}'_2)'$ of dimension $k = k_1 + k_2$:

$$Y_1 = \mathbf{x}' \beta + e$$

Instrumental Variable Conditions

Three conditions for valid instruments $\mathbf{z}$:

- 1 **Exogeneity:** $\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{z}e] = 0$ (instrument uncorrelated with structural error)
- 2 **Relevance:** $\text{rank } \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{z}\mathbf{x}'] = k$ (instruments predict endogenous regressors)
- 3 **Order condition:** $l \geq k$ (at least as many instruments as regressors)

- When $l = k$: **just identified** (exactly as many instruments as regressors)
- When $l > k$: **overidentified** ($q = l - k$ overidentifying restrictions)
- When $l < k$: **underidentified** (cannot estimate β)

Aside. Lagged values of the endogenous regressor are sometimes proposed as instruments. Whether the exclusion restriction holds depends on the autocorrelation structure of the structural error — developed in Lecture 18 (dynamic panels).

Example: Labeling the IV Setup

Do democratic institutions cause economic growth? (Acemoglu, Johnson & Robinson 2001)

- **Structural equation** ($Y_1 = \mathbf{x}'_1\beta_1 + \mathbf{y}'_2\beta_2 + e$):

$$\text{GDP/capita}_i = \beta_1 \text{Latitude}_i + \beta_2 \underbrace{\text{Institutions}_i}_{\mathbf{y}_2: \text{endogenous}} + e_i$$

- **Endogeneity:** Richer countries may adopt better institutions (reverse causality); omitted factors (geography, culture) affect both.
- **Excluded instrument** ($\mathbf{z}_2$): Colonial settler mortality.
 - **Relevance:** High settler mortality $\Rightarrow$ extractive colonies $\Rightarrow$ weak institutions today.
 - **Exogeneity:** Historical disease environment affects current GDP only through institutions (exclusion restriction — debatable!).

Reduced Form: Definitions

- The **reduced form** expresses all endogenous variables as functions of instruments only.
- For the endogenous regressors $\mathbf{y}_2$ ($k_2 \times 1$):

$$\mathbf{y}_2 = \Gamma' \mathbf{z} + \mathbf{u}_2 = \Gamma'_{12} \mathbf{z}_1 + \Gamma'_{22} \mathbf{z}_2 + \mathbf{u}_2, \quad \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{z} \mathbf{u}_2'] = 0$$

where Γ is $l \times k_2$, defined by $\Gamma = \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{z} \mathbf{z}']^{-1} \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{z} \mathbf{y}_2']$.

- The full projection of all regressors $\mathbf{x} = (\mathbf{x}_1', \mathbf{y}_2')'$ on $\mathbf{z}$:

$$\bar{\Gamma} = \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{I}_{k_1} & \Gamma_{12} \\ \mathbf{0} & \Gamma_{22} \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{I}_{k_1} & \Gamma \end{bmatrix} = \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{z} \mathbf{z}']^{-1} \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{z} \mathbf{x}']$$

- Key: OLS consistently estimates Γ and $\bar{\Gamma}$ because $\mathbf{z}$ is exogenous.

Reduced Form for Y

- Plugging the reduced form for y_2 into the structural equation:

$$\begin{aligned} Y_1 &= \mathbf{z}_1' \beta_1 + (\Gamma_{12}' \mathbf{z}_1 + \Gamma_{22}' \mathbf{z}_2 + \mathbf{u}_2)' \beta_2 + e \\ &= \mathbf{z}_1' \underbrace{(\beta_1 + \Gamma_{12} \beta_2)}_{\lambda_1} + \mathbf{z}_2' \underbrace{\Gamma_{22} \beta_2}_{\lambda_2} + \underbrace{(\mathbf{u}_2' \beta_2 + e)}_{u_1} \\ &= \mathbf{z}' \lambda + u_1 \end{aligned}$$

- The **structural** parameters are β_1, β_2 .
- The **reduced form** parameters are λ, Γ .
- Relationship: $\lambda = \bar{\Gamma} \beta$.

Reduced Form: The AJR Example

- **Structural equation** (what we want):

$$\text{GDP}_i = \beta_1 \text{Lat}_i + \beta_2 \text{Institutions}_i + e_i$$

- **First stage** (reduced form for y_2):

$$\text{Institutions}_i = \underbrace{\Gamma_{12}}_{\text{Lat coeff}} \text{Lat}_i + \underbrace{\Gamma_{22}}_{\text{Mortality coeff}} \text{SettlerMort}_i + u_{2i}$$

- **Reduced form for Y :**

$$\text{GDP}_i = \underbrace{\lambda_1}_{=\beta_1 + \Gamma_{12}\beta_2} \text{Lat}_i + \underbrace{\lambda_2}_{=\Gamma_{22}\beta_2} \text{SettlerMort}_i + u_{1i}$$

- λ_2 is the “reduced form effect” of settler mortality on GDP.
- The structural parameter: $\beta_2 = \lambda_2 / \Gamma_{22}$ (ratio of reduced form to first stage).

Identification

- β is **identified** if it is the unique solution to the moment conditions:

$$\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{z}(Y_1 - \mathbf{x}'\beta)] = 0$$

- This is a system of l equations in k unknowns.
- **Just identified** ($l = k$): unique solution $\beta = (\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{z}\mathbf{x}'])^{-1}\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{z}Y_1]$
- Equivalently: if $\bar{\Gamma}$ has rank k , then $\beta = (\bar{\Gamma}'\bar{\Gamma})^{-1}\bar{\Gamma}'\lambda$.
- **Overidentified** ($l > k$): system is overdetermined.
 - No exact solution in general — we need a method to combine the moment conditions.
 - Foreshadowing: this is exactly the problem GMM solves (Lecture 15).
- The **relevance condition** ($\text{rank } \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{z}\mathbf{x}'] = k$) is what makes the solution exist.

IV Estimator: Just-Identified Case

- When $l = k$, the **IV estimator** is the sample analogue of the moment condition:

$$\hat{\beta}_{IV} = (Z'X)^{-1}Z'Y$$

- Decompose:

$$\begin{aligned}\hat{\beta}_{IV} &= (Z'X)^{-1}Z'(X\beta + e) \\ &= \beta + (Z'X)^{-1}Z'e\end{aligned}$$

- Consistency: $\text{plim } \hat{\beta}_{IV} = \beta + (E[ZX'])^{-1}E[Ze] = \beta$ under exogeneity.

Indirect Least Squares

- **ILS**: Estimate reduced forms by OLS, then recover β .
- Reduced form estimates:

$$\hat{\Gamma} = (Z'Z)^{-1}Z'X, \quad \hat{\lambda} = (Z'Z)^{-1}Z'Y$$

- When $l = k$: $\hat{\beta}_{ILS} = \hat{\Gamma}^{-1}\hat{\lambda}$
- Show equivalence:

$$\begin{aligned}\hat{\beta}_{ILS} &= [(Z'Z)^{-1}Z'X]^{-1}(Z'Z)^{-1}Z'Y \\ &= (Z'X)^{-1}(Z'Z)(Z'Z)^{-1}Z'Y \\ &= (Z'X)^{-1}Z'Y = \hat{\beta}_{IV}\end{aligned}$$

- ILS = IV in the just-identified case.

The Wald Estimator

- Special case: single endogenous X , single binary instrument $Z \in \{0, 1\}$.
- The IV estimator simplifies to the **Wald estimator**:

$$\hat{\beta}_{Wald} = \frac{\bar{Y}_{Z=1} - \bar{Y}_{Z=0}}{\bar{X}_{Z=1} - \bar{X}_{Z=0}} = \frac{\text{Reduced form effect on } Y}{\text{First stage effect on } X}$$

- Intuition: scale the **intent-to-treat** (ITT) effect by the first-stage compliance rate.
- This is a ratio of two consistent estimators — a **ratio estimator**.

The Wald/IV estimator is the ratio of the reduced form to the first stage. This “ratio” structure is central to understanding IV.

Wald Estimator: Draft Lottery and Civic Participation

- **Question:** Does military service increase political participation?
- Y = voter turnout, X = served in military, Z = draft lottery number (low = drafted).
- **Reduced form:** $\bar{Y}_{Z=\text{low}} - \bar{Y}_{Z=\text{high}}$ = effect of lottery on turnout (ITT).
- **First stage:** $\bar{X}_{Z=\text{low}} - \bar{X}_{Z=\text{high}}$ = effect of lottery on service rate.

$$\hat{\beta}_{Wald} = \frac{\text{ITT on turnout}}{\text{First stage compliance}} = \frac{\text{Reduced form}}{\text{First stage}}$$

- Not everyone drafted actually serves (deferments, exemptions).
- The Wald estimator rescales the ITT by the share who comply with the draft.

Two-Stage Least Squares

- When $l > k$ (overidentified), we need 2SLS.
- **Stage 1:** Regress X on Z :

$$\hat{X} = P_Z X, \quad P_Z = Z(Z'Z)^{-1}Z'$$

- **Stage 2:** Regress Y on $\hat{X}$:

$$\hat{\beta}_{2SLS} = (\hat{X}'\hat{X})^{-1}\hat{X}'Y = (X'P_ZX)^{-1}X'P_ZY$$

- The projection P_Z extracts the **exogenous variation** in X — the part predicted by instruments.

2SLS = IV When Just Identified

- When $l = k$, $P_Z = Z(Z'Z)^{-1}Z'$ and:

$$\begin{aligned}\hat{\beta}_{2SLS} &= (\hat{X}'\hat{X})^{-1}\hat{X}'Y \\ &= (X'P_ZX)^{-1}X'P_ZY \\ &= (X'Z(Z'Z)^{-1}Z'X)^{-1}X'Z(Z'Z)^{-1}Z'Y \\ &= (Z'X)^{-1}(Z'Z)(X'Z)^{-1}X'Z(Z'Z)^{-1}Z'Y && ((ABC)^{-1} = C^{-1}B^{-1}A^{-1}) \\ &= (Z'X)^{-1}Z'Y = \hat{\beta}_{IV}\end{aligned}$$

- 2SLS generalizes IV to the overidentified case.

R Implementation

```
library(estimatr)

# 2SLS estimation
# Y ~ endogenous + exogenous | excluded_instruments + exogenous
fit_iv <- iv_robust(Y ~ D + X | Z + X, data = dat)
summary(fit_iv)
```

- Variables before “|” are the structural equation regressors.
- Variables after “|” are the instruments (excluded + included).
- `iv_robust` uses heteroskedasticity-robust standard errors by default.

Consistency of 2SLS (Hansen Thm. 12.1)

Theorem (Consistency)

Under the conditions: (1) $E[Ze] = 0$, (2) $\text{rank } E[ZX'] = k$, (3) $E[ZZ'] > 0$, the 2SLS estimator is consistent: $\hat{\beta}_{2SLS} \xrightarrow{P} \beta$.

Proof sketch:

$$\hat{\beta}_{2SLS} - \beta = \left(\frac{X'P_Z X}{n} \right)^{-1} \frac{X'P_Z e}{n}$$

Define $Q_{XZ} = E[XZ']$, $Q_{ZZ} = E[ZZ']$, $Q_{ZX} = E[ZX']$. Then:

$$\xrightarrow{P} (Q_{XZ} Q_{ZZ}^{-1} Q_{ZX})^{-1} Q_{XZ} Q_{ZZ}^{-1} \underbrace{E[Z'e]}_{=0} = 0$$

Just-Identified IV: Asymptotic Distribution

- For just-identified IV ($l = k$), $\hat{\beta}_{IV} = (Z'X)^{-1}Z'Y$, and

$$\sqrt{n}(\hat{\beta}_{IV} - \beta) = \left(\frac{Z'X}{n} \right)^{-1} \frac{Z'e}{\sqrt{n}}.$$

- WLLN: $\frac{Z'X}{n} \xrightarrow{p} Q \equiv \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{z}\mathbf{z}']$ ($k \times k$ since $l = k$).
- CLT: $\frac{Z'e}{\sqrt{n}} \xrightarrow{d} N(0, \Omega)$, $\Omega \equiv \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{z}\mathbf{z}'e^2]$.
- Slutsky:

$$\sqrt{n}(\hat{\beta}_{IV} - \beta) \xrightarrow{d} N(0, Q^{-1}\Omega Q^{-1'}).$$

The general 2SLS sandwich (next slide) reduces to this when $l = k$.

Asymptotic Distribution (Hansen Thm. 12.2)

Theorem (Asymptotic Normality)

Under regularity conditions:

$$\sqrt{n}(\hat{\beta}_{2SLS} - \beta) \xrightarrow{d} N(0, V_\beta)$$

where:

$$V_\beta = (Q_{XZ} Q_{ZZ}^{-1} Q_{ZX})^{-1} Q_{XZ} Q_{ZZ}^{-1} \Omega Q_{ZZ}^{-1} Q_{ZX} (Q_{XZ} Q_{ZZ}^{-1} Q_{ZX})^{-1}$$

with $Q_{XZ} = E[\mathbf{x}_i \mathbf{z}_i']$, $Q_{ZZ} = E[\mathbf{z}_i \mathbf{z}_i']$, $Q_{ZX} = E[\mathbf{z}_i \mathbf{x}_i']$, $\Omega = E[\mathbf{z}_i \mathbf{z}_i' e_i^2]$.

- Under homoskedasticity ($E[e^2 | Z] = \sigma^2$), this simplifies to:

$$V_\beta = \sigma^2 (Q_{XZ} Q_{ZZ}^{-1} Q_{ZX})^{-1}$$

- Under heteroskedasticity, use robust covariance estimation (as in Lecture 8).

Sample Analogs: Plug-in Variance for Just-Identified IV

- Replace population moments with sample averages. Form residuals $\hat{e}_i = Y_i - \mathbf{x}_i' \hat{\beta}_{IV}$ (using the original $\mathbf{x}_i$, not $\hat{\mathbf{x}}_i$).
- Sample analogs:

$$\hat{Q} = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n \mathbf{z}_i \mathbf{x}_i', \quad \hat{\Omega} = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n \mathbf{z}_i \mathbf{z}_i' \hat{e}_i^2.$$

$$\widehat{\text{Var}}(\hat{\beta}_{IV}) = \frac{1}{n} \hat{Q}^{-1} \hat{\Omega} \hat{Q}^{-1'}$$

- **What you do with data:** compute $\hat{Q}$ as a matrix of cross-products, compute residuals, compute $\hat{\Omega}$ as a $\mathbf{z}\mathbf{z}'$ -weighted average of squared residuals, sandwich them.
- Under conditional homoskedasticity $\hat{\Omega} = \hat{\sigma}^2 \hat{Q}_{ZZ}$, recovering the classical formula.

Variance Estimation: 2SLS

- **Homoskedastic** variance estimator:

$$\hat{V}_\beta = \hat{\sigma}^2 (X' P_Z X)^{-1}, \quad \hat{\sigma}^2 = \frac{\hat{e}' \hat{e}}{n - k}$$

where $\hat{e} = Y - X\hat{\beta}_{2SLS}$ (use **original** X , not $\hat{X}$).

- **Heteroskedastic-robust** (analogous to HC):

$$\hat{V}_\beta = (X' P_Z X)^{-1} \left(\sum_{i=1}^n \hat{e}_i^2 \hat{X}_i \hat{X}_i' \right) (X' P_Z X)^{-1}$$

- Important: Standard errors from the “naive” second-stage regression (regressing Y on $\hat{X}$ and reading off SEs) are **incorrect** — they use $\hat{X}$ instead of X in the residuals.

Wald Tests with IV/2SLS

- To test the linear restriction $H_0 : \mathbf{R}\beta = \mathbf{r}$ (q restrictions), form

$$W_n = n(\mathbf{R}\hat{\beta} - \mathbf{r})'(\mathbf{R}\hat{V}\mathbf{R}')^{-1}(\mathbf{R}\hat{\beta} - \mathbf{r}) \xrightarrow{d} \chi_q^2,$$

where $\hat{V} = \hat{Q}^{-1}\hat{\Omega}\hat{Q}^{-1'}$ (just-identified) or the 2SLS sandwich (overidentified).

- Reject H_0 at level α if $W_n > \chi_{q,1-\alpha}^2$. For a single coefficient: $t = \sqrt{W_n}$, compare to ± 1.96 .

Example: equality of IV slopes across two independent samples.

- Sample 1 (e.g., women), sample 2 (e.g., men), each just identified, separate $\hat{\beta}_j$, $\hat{V}_j$.
- Independence (different individuals) $\Rightarrow \hat{\beta}_1 \perp \hat{\beta}_2$ asymptotically.
- Test $H_0 : \beta_1 = \beta_2$ via

$$W_n = n(\hat{\beta}_1 - \hat{\beta}_2)'(\hat{V}_1 + \hat{V}_2)^{-1}(\hat{\beta}_1 - \hat{\beta}_2) \xrightarrow{d} \chi_k^2.$$

IV as a Method of Moments

- The IV estimator solves the **sample moment condition**:

$$\frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n Z_i(Y_i - X_i'\beta) = 0$$

- This is a system of l equations in k unknowns.
- When $l = k$: exactly identified, unique solution.
- When $l > k$: overidentified, no exact solution.
- **2SLS resolves this** by using a specific weighting matrix:

$$\hat{\beta}_{2SLS} = \arg \min_{\beta} \left[\frac{1}{n} \sum Z_i(Y_i - X_i'\beta) \right]' (Z'Z/n)^{-1} \left[\frac{1}{n} \sum Z_i(Y_i - X_i'\beta) \right]$$

IV Through the Theory-to-Moment Workflow

Recall the workflow from Lecture 6:

- 1 Mechanism:** X causes Y , but X is endogenous ($\mathbb{E}[X_i e_i] \neq 0$).
- 2 Exogenous feature:** An instrument Z is independent of e by institutional design, randomization, or natural experiment.
- 3 Observable implication:** Z predicts X but is uncorrelated with the structural error.
- 4 Moment condition:** $\mathbb{E}[Z_i(Y_i - X_i'\beta)] = 0$ (replacing X_i with Z_i).
- 5 Estimator:** $\hat{\beta}_{IV} = (Z'X)^{-1}Z'Y$.

The key move: When the OLS moment condition $\mathbb{E}[X_i e_i] = 0$ fails, IV does not abandon the moment-condition framework—it **substitutes a different, credible moment condition**. The question remains: *why should this moment hold?*

Foreshadowing GMM

- 2SLS uses the weighting matrix $\hat{W} = (Z'Z/n)^{-1}$.
- Is this the **optimal** weighting?
 - Under homoskedasticity: **yes**.
 - Under heteroskedasticity: **no** — there exists a more efficient choice.
- The **Generalized Method of Moments** (GMM) chooses $\hat{W}$ optimally:

$$\hat{W}_{opt} = \hat{\Omega}^{-1}, \quad \hat{\Omega} = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n \hat{e}_i^2 Z_i Z_i'$$

- GMM also extends beyond linear IV to **any** set of moment conditions.
- Next week: we develop the full GMM framework.

Summary

- 1 Endogeneity ($E[Xe] \neq 0$) makes OLS inconsistent for structural parameters.
- 2 Instruments Z satisfying exogeneity and relevance allow consistent estimation.
- 3 The IV estimator $\hat{\beta}_{IV} = (Z'X)^{-1}Z'Y$ works when just identified.
- 4 2SLS $\hat{\beta}_{2SLS} = (X'P_ZX)^{-1}X'P_ZY$ generalizes to overidentification.
- 5 Both are consistent and asymptotically normal under standard conditions.
- 6 IV is a **method of moments** — 2SLS is a specific weighting of moment conditions.

Next lecture: Finite sample properties, testing, LATE, and the MTE framework.